

Natural History





About the Course

Students learn to observe a variety of creatures through their Nature Reader, including insects, birds, plants, and spiders. Coordinating afternoon activities are provided in Outdoor Work.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Science: Grade 1

About Science: Grade 1

In Level 1, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through the most accessible Things, simple text, and basic concepts.

Science: Grade 1

The Big Picture:

To accomplish the goal of supporting a relationship with the Things of the Universe, a Mason science program consists of nature lore, natural history, and general science. Nature immersion, inquiry, community connection, and supportive literature are woven into each of these three parts. Form 1 learners in Grades 1-3 are at the beginning of this relationship: developing familiarity and friendship with Creation. Their sense of community is primarily focused on their immediate environment at this stage, but they are curious about others. The familiarity with foundational knowledge grown and nurtured in Form 1 prepares them for greater curiosity and personal interest in Form 2.

Nature lore is timeless knowledge that is passed through a community, much like a grandmother passes on how to make that special bread when the dough just 'feels right.' Like Mason, we strive to pass on this knowledge primarily through outdoor work. Group nature walks, seasonal readings, and topics in scouting are provided as an Outdoor Work resource in the Quick Links. If desired, literature suggestions to support lore can be found in the Community Read Alouds resource (in Literature Grades 1-3).



Placement & Combining Tips

About Science: Grade 1

In Level 1, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through the most accessible Things, simple text, and basic concepts.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1	Natural History: Grade 1 1 time/week 10 min	Walks with a Naturalist: Living Nature Reader Volume 1

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Science: Grade 1				
Natural History: Grade 1 Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8	Nature Notebook: Grade 1		General Science: Grade 1	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Science: Grade 1

- ☐ Obtain any supplies indicated on the science or grade-level supply lists.
- ☐ Download any apps and shortcut any desired links.

Nature Lore:

- ☐ Bookmark your Outdoor Work Quick Link, so that you have it available on your weekly outing. Outdoor Work is generally flexible for your location and season and can be moved around in the schedule to incorporate or substitute Natural History Club outings.
- ☐ Print or bookmark grade-specific nature notebook suggestions to support natural history and general science. Notebooking can be done on a walk, during occupations, or as a field trip, as appropriate.

Special Topics & Field Trips

Science: Grade 1

- ☐ Learn a few of your local species on these special topics using the internet, field guides, or your local nature preserve, conservancy, or state/national park.
- ☐ Note whether there are particular locations nearby for the student to easily notice the special topics on walks or during afternoon occupations.

Natural History: Grade 1

- Term 1: insects, spiders, and birds
- Term 2: wild seeds and birds
- Term 3: insects, spiders, and tree buds

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Science: Grade 1

Object lesson prompts are woven into the lessons as appropriate, but teachers are encouraged to read corresponding Handbook of Nature Study (HoNS) selections each term:

Natural History: Grade 1

- ☐ Term 1: ants p.369-374, bees p.384-395
- ☐ Term 2: squirrels p.233-237, 1-2 species of birds from p.50-141
- ☐ Term 3: lightning bugs p.367-368, spiders p.435-446



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Natural History: Grade 1



Walks with a Naturalist: Living Nature Reader Volume 1



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 13: Science\)](#)
- ∞ [Outdoor Work](#)
- ∞ [Seek app from iNaturalist](#)
- ∞ [SkyView Lite for Android](#)
- ∞ [SkyView Lite for iOS](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Natural History: Grade 1

How To Teach



Introduce

- Begin each lesson with learners' existing knowledge. If the book or activity is new or unfamiliar, then look at the title, a picture, or guidance in the lesson plan to help discuss what students think, drawing on previous experience. If continuing or revisiting a topic or activity, then recap. The lesson plans often help with this.
- Some learners may benefit from using pictures or looking back briefly.
- Allow them time to share any concerns and come alongside, as needed.



Complete

- Read, or do, as instructed in the lessons, noting any Teacher Tips provided. Learners should always have their nature journal or some other notebook/paper available in case they need to draw or diagram during the lesson.
- When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- If learners do not understand a word or concept, do not worry. Try to show them with a picture or connect the idea to something they have seen in real life. They are learning much by the way and will likely build understanding over the term, the year, or beyond.



Narrate

- Process the ideas of the lesson by retelling the events in sequence, describing a scene or setting, explaining a concept, etc.
- Learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.



Discuss

- Consider together any thoughts, confusion, or concerns about the passage.
- Questions/topics for further discussion are often provided in the lesson plans to help. There are no right or wrong answers to these. If teachers want to keep ideas active in the mind, these can also be used at other times to keep the ideas in the working memory.



Connect

- Follow any extra links, examine any sidebars in the text, look at pictures, etc., depending on learner interest.
- These can also be viewed as alternative ways to engage.

Natural History: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 1

A Sense of Fall

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Have you ever gone on a walk with a naturalist or park ranger? If so, what was that like? These are people who spend a LOT of time getting to know nature. This book has been written especially for YOU by a naturalist! Today, she is going to introduce herself and help us start to think about the upcoming season. She'll take us on her walks all year long!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.xvii-3 "Hello, readers!" - "go outside!"

Read the definitions and notes at the end of each reading, as desired.

- When you think about the fall season, what do you think of? What do you look forward to? Have you noticed any of these signs of fall yet?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Fall Colors in Texas (2:08)

∞ Video Link: Wood Thrush Song (1:35)

∞ Video Link: Senses Nature Walk (6:34)

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 2 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 2

Shake a Bush

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Look at the picture on p.4. Have you ever seen a creature like this before? What kinds of 'bugs' have you noticed? Briefly share in word or picture.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.4-6 "One of my" - "can you find?"

- What do you think makes a leafhopper a leafhopper? What does it do? How is it made?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Jumping Hoppers in Slow Motion (1:44-3:23)

★ TEACHER TIP

It can sometimes be unnerving for students not to get an immediate answer to a question. Encourage them to sit with big questions, like the one in today's suggested discussion, while they continue to make observations.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 3 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 3

Ants in My Plants

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Draw a picture or diagram of an ant or other insect (or a partner might diagram alongside a verbal drawing). What parts do you recall?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.8-11 "In 'Shake'" - "and differences!"

- Compare the ant on p.9 to the leafhopper on p.5. How are they similar? How are they different?

★ TEACHER TIP

If students need support drawing or diagramming, the teacher may do any activities with them in tandem or act as their scribe.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

- Add to the drawing you did before the reading or draw a new one. Can you remember the parts of an insect? (3 body segments, 6 legs)
- Have you noticed insects outside? What were they doing? Where were they? What made that place a good home?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: All the Life Stages of an Ant (1:34)
- ∞ Video Link: Flying Ants Up Close (5:22)

WEEK 4 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 4

Splooting and Anting

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

Recall what we read. Tell about or draw/diagram an insect. What parts do you recall? Ants live with other creatures in nature. Do you think you would like to live with ants? Why or why not? What do you think the bird is doing in the picture on p.13?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13-15 "I love" - "around them!"

- Have you ever noticed animals doing funny or curious things?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Sploot Season (0:55)
- ∞ Video Link: Birds Bathing on an Ant Hill (2:22)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 5 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 5

Hot Ants

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell about our last reading. What do you remember about insects? Briefly share in word or picture.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.16-19 "When Mike" - "live in?"

- Have you noticed an ant's home before? Describe what you noticed.
- Did you know that insects could be farmers? What kinds of work have you seen ants doing?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Ant Farm Time Lapse (3:20)
- ∞ Video Link: Ants Farming Aphids (2:01)

★ TEACHER TIP

Notice that any prompt to recall or think about can be done verbally, in picture, or in any other way that suits the student(s). Apply this flexibility to all lessons.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 6 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 6

Counting Bumbles

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

What do you remember about our last reading? Look at the picture on p.20. Do you know who that is? We're going to read about another insect today and find out why he's in that tube. If it's an insect, what body parts does that mean it will have? (6 legs and 3 body segments: head, thorax,

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your

Natural History: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

abdomen)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.20-24 "Did you know" - "nature journal."

- Bumble bees are insects just like ants and leafhoppers. Looking at the picture on p.22, how is the bumble bee different from ants and leafhoppers?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Bumble bees in slow motion (watch as much as you want, trying to notice the legs, body segments, and any other interesting features or behaviors)

student(s).

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links. Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 7 10m Natural History: Grade 1- Lesson 7

Scary Spider? No Way!

 Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me what we've been reading about. Look at the picture on p.25. Does this creature have three body segments and six legs, like the ant and bumble bee? How many body segments and how many legs does the spider have? Spiders are not insects! Have you ever watched a spider or seen a spider web before? Tell about it.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.25-28 "I used to be" - "look like?"

- What do you want to notice about the next spider web you find? Where do you think an orb weaver would make its home?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Orb Weavers (1:22)

∞ Video Link: Amazing Spider with Huge Web (3:15)

★ TEACHER TIP

It can sometimes be unnerving for students not to get an immediate answer to a question. Encourage them to sit with big questions, like the one in today's suggested discussion, while they continue to make observations.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 8 10m Natural History: Grade 1- Lesson 8

Cute Spiders?

 Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Remind me what we read about last. How was the garden spider we met last week different from the insects we met earlier in the book? Let's meet another spider today. Compare the pictures on p.27, 30. How are the spiders similar? How are they different?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.30-33 "Do you think" - "your mind!"

- Did you notice how some jumping spiders make their home in a leaf? Where do you think they might live outside? That place where they find food and shelter is their habitat!

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Spider with Super Powers (4:00)

★ TEACHER NOTE

The spider in the supplemental video catches prey, which some students might find disturbing. Teachers should preview or skip this one if they have concerns.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 9 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 9

Chimney Swift Tornado

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

What are some of the creatures we've read about this term? Where do they live and find habitat (a place with food and shelter) in the world around us? Do they ever come into your home? Do we share the same habitat as insects and spiders or are their homes separate from ours? Today we'll read about a bird whose habitat is definitely part of someone else's! Look at the picture on p.34.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.34-36 "One evening" - "they roost?"

- If our homes are part of the natural world, then the creatures in nature are our neighbors! Tell how you care for your neighbors, human or animal.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Chimney Swifts (0:45)

∞ Video Link: Portland Swift Tornado (watch as much as you like)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 10 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 10

Yard Elk

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

Tell what you remember about the chimney swift. Have you noticed any bird neighbors this week? What were they doing? Have you noticed signs that they may be getting ready for a change in season? Today our naturalist friend tells us about another animal neighbor that she is getting to know.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.38-40 "Today, a herd" - "for winter?"

- How do you think animals that live outside all year round survive in very cold seasons?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Elk in the Ozarks (2:19)

∞ Video Link: Bighorn Sheep, another ruminant in a different habitat (3:20)

∞ Video Link: White-tailed Deer, another ruminant in a different habitat (2:32)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 11 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 11

Catch Up

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons, watch some videos that you didn't have time for, or discuss some interesting ideas over a snack. Depending on your discussions, these MIGHT include:

- What do you remember about ants?
- How are bees similar to and different from ants?
- How are spiders different from insects?
- Other creatures as our neighbors.
- Signs of the season with all our senses and signs that animals are preparing for that season.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 12 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Walks with a Naturalist 1

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 13

Sticky Seeds

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Look at the picture on p.41. Did you ever find stuff stuck to you after you went out to play or walk? What did it look like? Where did it come from?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.41-42 "Sometimes Mike" - "closer look!"

Read the notes and definitions at the end of each reading, as desired.

- Have you ever seen the seeds of a wild plant? If so, briefly tell about it.
- Tell a story about where a seed goes and how it finds its new home after it sticks to an animal.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Showy Tick Trefoil (1:07)

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

● OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 2 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 14

Pinecone Bombs

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Remind me about the seeds we read about last week. Look at the picture on p.44. What do you suppose the squirrel is doing on that branch?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.44-46 "Mike and I" - "seeds inside!"

- Last week, we met a plant that helps its seeds move by making them sticky. How did this week's plant help its seeds move? (Might mention animals eating or burying, wind). Can you think of other ways that seeds move around to find a good home? How is the seed helped by the way it was made?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Pine Tree Time Lapse (1:55)

∞ Image Link: Winged seeds of Norway Spruce

★ TEACHER TIP

It can sometimes be unnerving for students not to get an immediate answer to a question. Encourage them to sit with big questions, like the one in today's suggested discussion, while they continue to make observations.

● OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 3 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 15

The Bird with the Best Memory

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

Let's remember the seeds we've read about so far and how they move around. Today, we're going to read about a different kind of pine seed and an animal that helps this plant move around.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.48-50 "One fall morning" - "your dinner!"

- Have you noticed a bird stuffing its mouth or flying busily back and forth at the bird feeder? Maybe it was caching! Act like the bird and show what it did.

● OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

- A keystone species is a creature that many other creatures rely on. Have you noticed a tree that many other creatures rely on? Tell about it.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Clark's Nutcracker (1:35)
- ∞ Video Link: American Crow preparing to cache (1:29)
- ∞ Website Link: All About Birds, scroll down to see some different birds that cache and the different strategies they use

WEEK 4 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 16

A Bear-y Nice Tree

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

What kinds of seeds have we been reading about? Tell me about the animals that like to eat seeds and fruits. Today, let's read about one that Melissa observed in her yard.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.51-53 "Mike and I" - "eat the fruit!"

- What does the seed do for the plant? What does the seed do for the animals?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: The Outdoor Theater (16:57). Watch as much or as little as you like; watch on increased speed if short on time.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 5 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 17

Salamander Night Out

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

What kinds of creatures have we been reading about? Look at the picture on p.55. This is a very different kind of animal! What do you notice about the salamander?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.55-59 "It was a" - "of their own!"

- Have you seen a salamander before? If so, tell about it. Does the salamander remind you of any other creature? Have you seen its cousin, the frog?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Life cycle of a Salamander (3:39)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 6 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 18

Christmas Bird Count Part 1

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Recall who we read about last week. Do you remember the animals we read about before that? Where do you like to go to watch animals in nature? Let's read about a place where Melissa likes to go.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.60-62 "Every year" - "natural spectacle!"

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

Natural History: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

- Tell about the bird you see most at the feeder. How many different birds do you think you see at the feeder?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Counting the Birds (1:59)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 7 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 19 *Christmas Bird Count Part 2*

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

What did we read about last? Did you see birds this week? Did you hear birds this week? Let's find out what other birds Melissa noticed on her Count.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.63-66 "On our Christmas" - "can you find?"

- Is there a bird song you hear often? Can you sing that song? Have you seen who it belongs to? Where do you hear it?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Website Link: Sounds & Songs

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 8 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 20 *Flowers to Seeds*

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

Remind me of what we read about last time. What do birds eat during the winter? Look at the picture on p.67. What is that bird doing?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.67-70 "Our yard" - "a winter meal?"

- Tell about a place where you saw wildflowers in the summer or fall. Have you noticed who is eating at that flower in winter?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Goldfinches Eating (2:59)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 9 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 21 *The Round House*

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

Tell me what we read about last week. Look at the picture on p.71. What do you notice? What do you think is going on in the picture?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.71-72 "I am" - "goldenrod gall fly!"

- Have you ever thought of what it would be like to be an insect? Tell a story about an insect you've seen from the insect's point-of-view.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: What Gall! (2:58)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 10 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 22

The Goldenrod Gall Fly

Materials: Website link

→ INTRO

What did we read about last? Look at the picture on p.74. What do you notice about this insect?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.74-78 "Mike and I" - "find a gall!"

- Galls are just one way that some insects raise their babies. If you have ever seen a wasp nest or bees emerging from the ground, then you've seen other homes for baby insects. Tell about any kinds of insect homes that you have seen.
- We often don't see many insects in the colder season, but if you watched either of the supplemental videos, can you see the parts that make these creatures insects? (3 body segments, 6 legs)

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Thistle Stem Gall Fly (0:22)

∞ Video Link: Oak Apple Gall Wasps (1:54)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 11 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 23

Catch Up

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons, watch some videos that you didn't have time for, or discuss some interesting ideas over a snack. Depending on your discussions, these MIGHT include:

- How does the shape and structure of a seed help the plant move its seed to a new home?
- How do animals help plants? How do plants help animals? (Think about squirrels, birds, bears, insects, etc.)
- Tell about salamanders.
- Tell about the different kinds of animal homes you can think of.
- What kinds of birds have you seen or heard?

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 12 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Walks with a Naturalist 1

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 25

Opening Buds

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Look at the picture on p.79. Did you know that trees have buds just like garden plants? What do you notice about this bud?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.79-82 "Every year" - "start to open!"

Read the notes and definitions at the end of each reading, as desired.

- What signs of spring have you noticed?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Oak Leaf Budding (0:32)

∞ Video Link: Beech Twig Flowers and Leaves Budding (1:22)

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 2 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 26

Spring Babies

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

What do you remember about buds opening from the last reading? Baby animals also emerge in the spring. Have you ever watched a baby animal?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.83-85 "In Yellowstone" - "on a farm."

- Have you spotted baby birds or other nature babies outside? What were they doing?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Baby Animals of Yellowstone (4:08)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 3 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 27

A Yard Bouquet

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

Tell me about the signs of new life that we've been reading about (buds and baby animals). New flowers are another sign of spring. Have you ever made a bouquet of wildflowers? Tell about your favorite wildflowers. Look at the picture of Melissa's favorite wildflowers on p.87. Do you know any of them?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.87-91 "In spring" - "look closely?"

- Tell about your favorite wildflower. When and where do you see it?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: California Wildflowers (0:49)

∞ Video Link: New York Wildflowers (0:59)

∞ Video Link: Desert Wildflowers (3:58)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 4 10m Natural History: Grade 1- Lesson 28

Rolling Logs

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

Remind me of what we read about last time. Have you ever thought of a dead tree as a sign of life? When you've been outside, have you ever come across a log on the ground? If so, tell what you noticed. Maybe you noticed someone like in the picture on p.92. What do you notice about this creature?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.92-96 "In our North" - "where you live!"
Be sure to read the safety note on p.97.

- How many different creatures did Melissa see under logs?
- What would happen if you rolled the log away from you instead of toward you while looking over?

∞ Video Link: Life Under a Rotting Log (5:29), similar to the one linked in your text

∞ Video Link: Earwig wings are origami-like (2:41)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 5 10m Natural History: Grade 1- Lesson 29

Tree Holes

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me about the log habitat we read about last week. Have you ever noticed a living tree with holes in it? If so, briefly tell about what you noticed. Today we're going to read about another way that trees provide a place for creatures to live and grow.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.98-101 "Have you ever" - "make their nests."

- Tell about the different creatures you have seen in a tree.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Mystery of the Tiny Tree Holes (4:17)

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 6 10m Natural History: Grade 1- Lesson 30

Baby Birdwatching

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Remind me what we read about last week. Look at the picture on p.102. What do you notice? Some birds build nests like this inside those tree holes, so let's peek inside with Melissa and see what's going on in there!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.102-105 "In our yard" - "and I did."

- What kinds of materials do you think birds make their nests from? If you were a bird, what would you make your nest from?

★ TEACHER TIP

It can sometimes be unnerving for students not to get an immediate answer to a question. Encourage them to sit with big questions, like the one in today's suggested discussion, while they continue to make observations.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Nest Box Time Lapse (10:25). This video is longer than usual; watch as much or as little as you want or use the chapters to watch portions, as desired.

∞ Video Link: 3 Bluebirds of North America (5:34)

WEEK 7 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 31

Spider Drums

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

Tell me who we met last week. Can you remember back to the spiders we've read about? (garden/orb weaver, jumping spider) Let's meet another spider this week because spiders are busy in the spring, too.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.106-107 "One spring" - "that sound?"

- What makes spiders different from the insects, such as the tree hoppers and ants? (Help students remember that insects have 3 body segments and 6 legs, while spiders have 2 body segments and 8 legs.)

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Mother Wolf Spider (0:50)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 8 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 32

Year of the Cicadas

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

Tell me who we met last week. Let's meet a very strange insect that we could observe in the spring. Look at the picture on p.108. What do you think this insect is doing? What do you notice?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.108-110 "I was born" - "also amazing?"

- Do you know if you have annual or periodical cicadas where you live? Have you noticed their exuvia on your walks?
- How is the cicada different from the wolf spider? (hint: insect vs spider)

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Billions of Cicadas (2:24)

∞ Video Link: How does the annual cicada call? (3:09)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 9 10m Natural History: Grade 1 - Lesson 33

Blue Ghosts

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

Tell me what you remember about cicadas. Look at the picture on p.112. What do you notice about this insect? This insect has a special trick that is very different from the cicada's.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.112-114 "One summer" - "near you."

- How is the blue ghost similar to the cicada (and the other insects we've met)? How is it different?

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

★ TEACHER TIP

If students catch fireflies during their outdoor time, this is a great opportunity for an object lesson.

Natural History: Grade 1

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Fireflies in North Carolina (7:03)
- ∞ Video Link: Think there aren't fireflies in the west? (4:00)
- ∞ Video Link: Catching and Chasing Fireflies (3:04)

WEEK 10 10m Natural History: Grade 1- Lesson 34

Sneaky Spider

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 1

→ INTRO

Tell me about the insects we've been reading about. Do you recall who we met before them? Today, we meet another spider.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.115-117 "Out in my - "catch their prey!"

- Have you ever noticed a spider or other animal that is good at camouflage? If so, tell about it.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Goldenrod Crab Spider (0:20)
- ∞ Video Link: Stealth Crab Spider (2:13)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 11 10m Natural History: Grade 1- Lesson 35

Catch Up

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons, watch some videos that you didn't have time for, or discuss some interesting ideas over a snack. Depending on your discussions, these MIGHT include:

- What signs of spring (opening buds, baby animals, wildflowers, spiders, insects, etc) have you noticed?
- Tell about surprising places where animals live, such as rotting logs and tree holes.
- Tell about interesting spiders and insects you have seen in the garden.
- Compare and contrast spiders and insects.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 12 10m Natural History: Grade 1- Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Walks with a Naturalist 1

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 1

Examination

- Term 1** · Walks with a Naturalist 1: Tell about or draw the ant or the bee. OR Tell about or draw the garden or jumping spider.
- Term 2** · Walks with a Naturalist 1: Tell about or draw a plant seed and explain how it moves to find a new home. OR Tell about or draw a bird that you have learned about.
- Term 3** · Tell how to roll a log and what you might find underneath it. OR Tell about or draw how spiders are different from insects.